FINAL PROJECT REPORT

Automated Incident Management Lifecycle

Using ServiceNow Incident Management

Name: Harsha Vardhan Vasana

Team ID: Individual

Platform: ServiceNow

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Incident Management | Service Operations Workspace

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

The project, “Automated Incident Management Lifecycle using ServiceNow,” is a ServiceNow-based solution designed to standardize and automate the complete incident lifecycle. It enables Service Desk agents to create and classify incidents, use Agent Assist knowledge, reassign incidents to Level 2 support, initiate emergency change requests, create child incidents, document cause and resolution, and generate knowledge aincidents.

Purpose:

The purpose is to provide a controlled, transparent, and traceable incident process inside Service Operations Workspace. The solution connects incident intake, classification, assignment, investigation, change integration, child-incident tracking, resolution, knowledge creation, and SLA visibility.

- Enable Service Desk agents to create and classify incidents consistently.
- Integrate Agent Assist and Knowledge Management for faster resolution.
- Reassign incidents to appropriate Level 2 support teams with clear ownership.
- Create emergency change requests directly from incidents when required.
- Create child incidents for recurring or related issues.
- Document probable cause, resolution code, and resolution notes.
- Generate Knowledge Articles from resolved incidents.
- Improve SLA compliance and service visibility.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

Service Desk agent perspective across incident intake, classification, investigation, resolution and knowledge reuse.

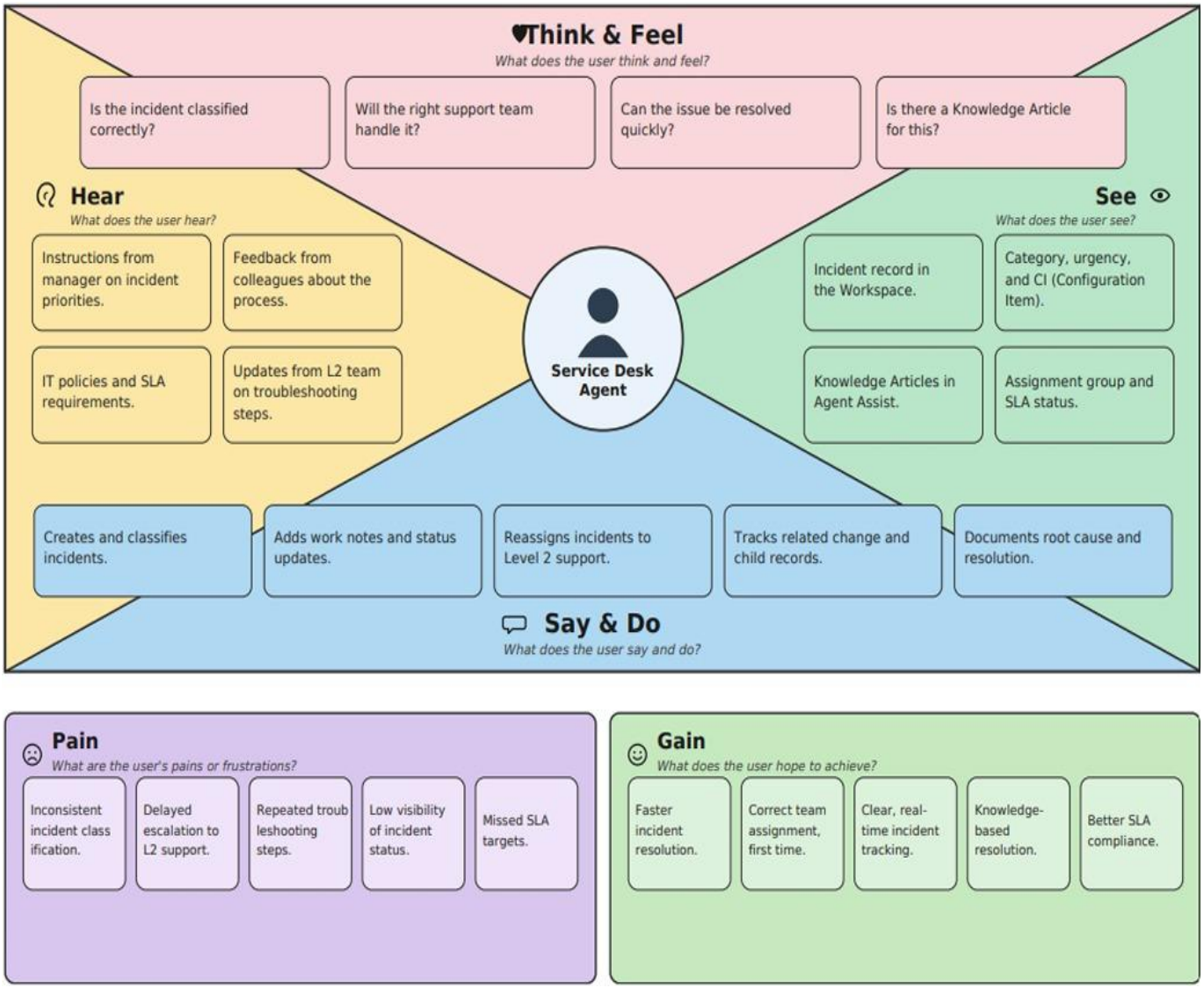


Figure 1. Empathy Map – Service Desk Agent / Incident Management

The agent seeks fast classification, clear ownership, useful knowledge, controlled changes, traceable resolution and reliable SLA visibility.

2.3 Customer Journey Map

The journey follows a Service Desk incident from recognition through classification, assistance, investigation, resolution and knowledge reuse.

Journey Stages	1. Awareness Recognize the incident	2. Classification Classify the incident	3. Knowledge & Assignment Find help & assign	4. Investigation & Change Diagnose & act	5. Resolution Resolve & document
Steps What does the user do at this stage?	• Identify the incident and confirm user impact.	• Open the incident in Service Operations Workspace and capture details.	• Review Agent Assist knowledge and route to the right support group.	• Investigate the issue, update the CI, and create an emergency change when required.	• Document cause and resolution, resolve the incident, and create knowledge.
Interactions Who or what do they interact with?	• End user Incident record Service Desk	• ServiceNow Workspace Category, urgency, service and CI fields	• Agent Assist Knowledge articles Network / Level 2 team	• Level 2 technicians Change Management Related Records	• Incident record Knowledge Management SLA / Activity history
Goals & Motivations What is the user trying to achieve?	• Understand the issue and record it correctly.	• Classify the incident accurately and avoid rework.	• Find a useful solution and ensure clear ownership.	• Restore service quickly with controlled change and documentation.	• Close the incident correctly and preserve reusable knowledge.
Positive Moments What do they find enjoyable or satisfying?	• Clear incident intake and complete information.	• Consistent classification and visible assignment.	• Relevant knowledge articles and quick escalation.	• Clear technical ownership and traceable change.	• Successful resolution, knowledge creation, and SLA visibility.
Negative Moments What do they find frustrating or confusing?	• Incomplete information or unclear issue description.	• Incorrect category, CI, or urgency causing rework.	• No relevant article or delayed reassignment.	• Repeated troubleshooting, delayed change, or unclear ownership.	• Incomplete resolution notes or poor visibility of related records.
Areas of Opportunity How can we make this better?	• Standardize incident intake and required information.	• Use guided classification for category, urgency, service and CI.	• Improve Agent Assist relevance and make escalation structured.	• Link emergency changes and child incidents directly to the incident.	• Generate knowledge from resolutions and strengthen SLA tracking.
Emotional Journey How do they feel throughout the journey?	Concerned	Hopeful	Waiting	Frustrated	Satisfied

Journey Insight

- Positive progression comes from accurate classification, relevant Agent Assist knowledge, clear ownership, and traceable resolution.
- Friction occurs when information is incomplete, escalation is delayed, troubleshooting is repeated, or related records are not linked.
- The opportunity is to standardize the lifecycle while keeping change, child incidents, knowledge and SLA records connected.

3.2 Solution Requirement

Functional Requirement

FR No.	Functional Requirement	Sub Requirement / Expected Behavior
FR-1	Incident Record Creation	Create incident in Service Operations Workspace and capture caller and short description.
FR-2	Incident Classification	Capture category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering, and CI.
FR-3	Agent Assist Knowledge	Show relevant Knowledge Articles based on incident details; attach and mark useful articles.
FR-4	Reassignment & Escalation	Reassign incident to Level 2 support and maintain clear task ownership.
FR-5	Emergency Change	Create and link an emergency change request directly from the incident when needed.
FR-6	Child Incident	Create related child incidents for recurring or related issues and track them.
FR-7	Resolution	Document probable cause, resolution code, and resolution notes; resolve incident.
FR-8	Knowledge Creation	Create a Knowledge Article from a resolved incident using the selected template.
FR-9	SLA & Related Records	Track SLA status and verify linked changes, children, and knowledge records.

Non-functional Requirements

NFR No.	Requirement	Description
NFR-1	Usability	Workspace and incident forms should be clear and easy for agents to use.
NFR-2	Security	Only authorized users and groups should update incidents and related records.
NFR-3	Reliability	Incident, change, child, knowledge, and SLA relationships should remain consistent.
NFR-4	Performance	Knowledge, assignment, and related-record operations should respond within acceptable time.
NFR-5	Traceability	Activity history should preserve work notes, assignment, resolution, and linked records.
NFR-6	Scalability	The process should support additional support groups, services, and knowledge content.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

The data flow shows how an IT incident moves through ServiceNow from intake to classification, knowledge assistance, escalation, change/child tracking, resolution and SLA visibility.



Data Flow Details

Source / Actor	Process	Data Flow	Record / Output
End User	Incident Reporting	Issue details, caller information	incident [INC]
Service Desk	Classification	Category, urgency, service, CI	incident [INC]
Agent Assist	Knowledge Support	Incident context / short description	Knowledge Article
Level 2 Support	Investigation	Work notes, CI updates	incident [INC]
Change Management	Emergency Change	Change details from incident	change_request [CHG]
Incident / Support	Child Incident	Related or recurring issue	incident [Child]
Resolution	Knowledge / SLA	Cause, resolution, SLA data	incident / Knowledge / SLA

Data Flow Summary

End User → Service Desk → Incident Classification → Agent Assist → Level 2 Investigation → Emergency Change / Child Incident → Resolution & Knowledge Creation → SLA Tracking.

3.4 Technology Stack

Component	Technology / ServiceNow Feature	Purpose
User Interface	Service Operations Workspace	Agent-facing incident creation, classification, and tracking.
Incident Management	Incident module / incident table	Stores and manages incident lifecycle.
Knowledge	Agent Assist / Knowledge Management	Finds, attaches, and creates reusable knowledge.
Assignment	Assignment Groups / Assigned To	Supports Service Desk and Level 2 ownership.
Change Integration	Emergency Change Request	Links change activity to incident resolution.
Related Records	Child Incidents / Related Lists	Tracks related and recurring incidents.
SLA	Task SLA / SLA related records	Provides service-level tracking and visibility.
Configuration	Service / Service Offering / CI	Connects incident to business service and technical asset.
Administration	ServiceNow platform configuration	Controls forms, workflows, access, and related records.

4. PROJECT DESIGN

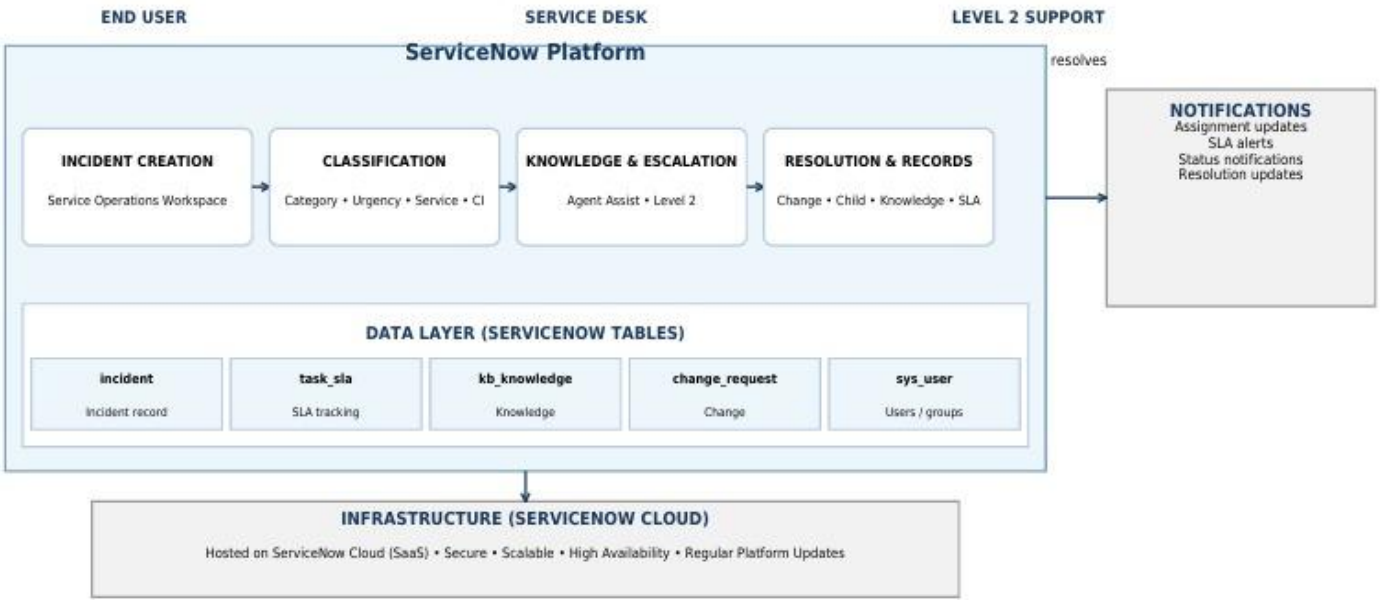
4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The problem-solution fit is achieved by replacing fragmented incident coordination with a standardized ServiceNow lifecycle. Agents receive structured classification fields, relevant knowledge, clear escalation, linked changes and child incidents, documented resolution, and reusable knowledge.

Canvas Area	Project-Specific Definition
Customer Segment	Service Desk agents and Level 2 support teams handling IT incidents.
Job-to-be-Done	Classify, investigate, escalate, resolve, and document incidents efficiently.
Root Cause	Manual coordination, incomplete classification, disconnected knowledge and change activities.
Available Solution	Incident module, Agent Assist, assignment groups, change integration, child incidents, Knowledge, SLAs.
Constraints	Support-team availability, correct configuration, permissions, and accurate incident data.
Solution	Standardized incident lifecycle with integrated related records and knowledge reuse.

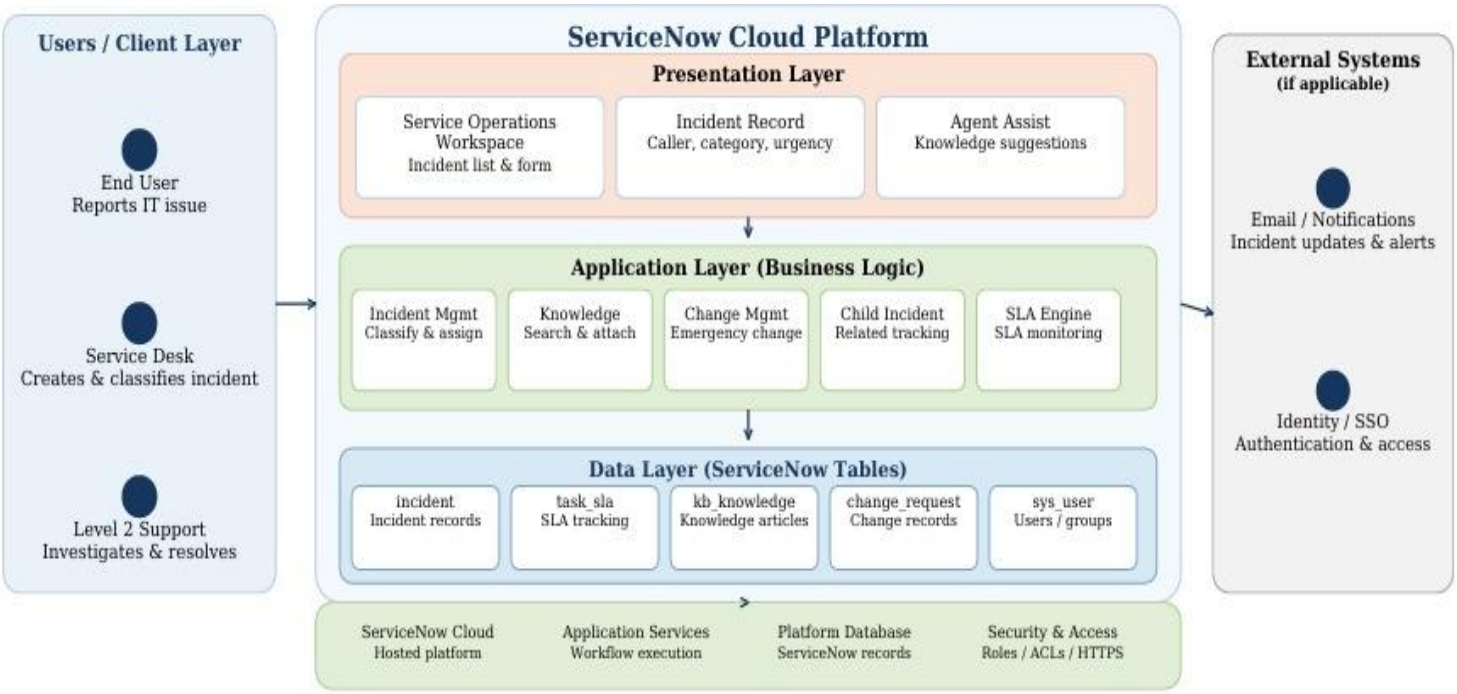
4.2 Proposed Solution

1. Create an incident in Service Operations Workspace with caller and short description.
2. Classify the incident using category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering, and CI.
3. Use Agent Assist to surface relevant Knowledge Articles and attach a useful article.
4. Add watchers and work-note followers where required for communication.
5. Reassign the incident from Service Desk to Network / Level 2 support when advanced investigation is required.
6. Update the Configuration Item and place the incident On Hold with reason Awaiting Change when appropriate.
7. Create an emergency change request from the incident and create a child incident for related/recurring work.
8. Document probable cause, resolution code, and resolution notes, then resolve the parent incident.
9. Create a Knowledge Article from the resolved incident and verify SLA and related-record tracking.



4.3 Solution Architecture

The architecture connects the Service Operations Workspace, incident data, Agent Assist, Level 2 support, change/child tracking, resolution, knowledge management and SLA visibility.



Architecture Components

Component	Purpose
Service Desk / Workspace	Creates and classifies incident records and maintains initial ownership.
Incident Data Layer	Stores caller, category, urgency, service, CI, state, notes, and assignment.
Agent Assist / Knowledge	Surfaces relevant articles and supports attachment of useful guidance.
Assignment & Level 2	Routes incidents to Network or other technical support groups.
Emergency Change	Provides controlled change execution for incidents requiring change activity.
Child Incident	Tracks related or recurring incidents without losing parent context.
Resolution	Captures probable cause, resolution code, notes, and final state.
Knowledge Management	Creates reusable articles from resolved incident knowledge.
SLA / Related Records	Provides service-level visibility and verifies linked activities.

5.1 Project Planning

The project is organized into four implementation sprints covering configuration, integration, validation and final lifecycle testing.

Sprint	User Story	Points	Planned Scope
Sprint-1	US-01 Incident creation & services	3	Create service, service offering, incident intake and required fields.
Sprint-1	US-02 Classification	3	Category, subcategory, urgency, service, CI, and work notes.
Sprint-2	US-03 Knowledge & Assignment	3	Agent Assist, article attachment, watchers, and Level 2 routing.
Sprint-2	US-04 Change Integration	3	Emergency change request and related record verification.
Sprint-3	US-05 Child Incident	2	Create and verify child incident tracking.
Sprint-3	US-06 Resolution	3	Cause, resolution code, notes, and parent/child resolution.
Sprint-4	US-07 Knowledge Creation	2	Create Knowledge Article from resolved incident.
Sprint-4	US-08 SLA & Final Validation	3	Validate SLA and complete end-to-end lifecycle.

Milestones

1. Incident Record Creation
2. Incident Classification
3. Knowledge Integration
4. Reassignment & Escalation
5. Change Request Creation
6. Child Incident Creation
7. Incident Resolution
8. Knowledge Creation
9. SLA & Related Record Validation

Skills

- Incident Management
- Agent Assist
- Change Management Integration
- Related Lists
- SLAs
- Knowledge Management

Lifecycle Coverage

- Create and classify incidents with complete context.
- Use knowledge and structured escalation for faster diagnosis.
- Integrate emergency changes and child incidents.
- Document cause and resolution, then create reusable knowledge.
- Validate SLA status and related records end to end.

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

Validation focuses on consistent processing of the incident lifecycle, related records, knowledge, assignment, and SLA information. The test cases confirm that configured operations work without missing relationships or workflow breaks.

S.No.	Parameter	Validation	Result
1	Incident Creation	Incident is created with caller and short description.	Pass
2	Classification	Category, subcategory, urgency, service, offering and CI are retained.	Pass
3	Agent Assist	Knowledge Articles appear and can be attached.	Pass
4	Assignment	Assignment group changes to Network and Assigned To clears when required.	Pass
5	Change	Emergency change can be created and linked to the incident.	Pass
6	Child Incident	Child incident is created and appears in Related Records.	Pass
7	Resolution	Cause, resolution code, notes and state are saved.	Pass
8	Knowledge	Knowledge Article is created from resolved incident.	Pass
9	SLA	SLA and related-record tracking remain visible.	Pass

End-to-End Validation

The complete lifecycle was structured for validation as: Incident Creation → Classification → Knowledge Assistance → Reassignment → Emergency Change / Child Incident → Cause & Resolution → Resolve → Knowledge Creation → SLA Verification.

7. RESULTS

Functional validation summary

Test Area	Expected Outcome	Status
Incident Creation	Incident record is accessible and required details can be submitted.	Pass
Classification	Incident fields retain the required service and technical context.	Pass
Knowledge & Agent Assist	Relevant articles can be opened, marked helpful, and attached.	Pass
Level 2 Assignment	Incident ownership moves to the correct support group.	Pass
Change Integration	Emergency change is linked to the incident.	Pass
Child Incident	Related child incident is visible from the parent.	Pass
Resolution	Cause and resolution documentation are retained.	Pass
Knowledge Creation	Resolved incident can generate a Knowledge Article.	Pass
SLA & Related Records	SLA and linked records remain visible.	Pass

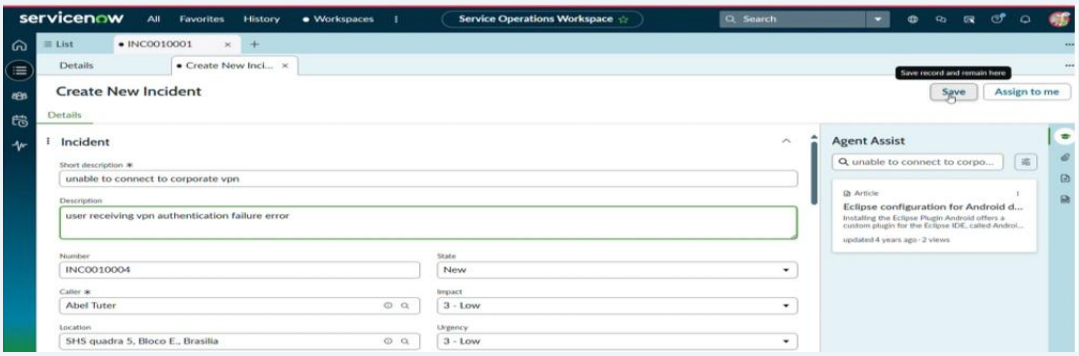
7.1 Output Screenshots

The final submission should include ServiceNow evidence for each major lifecycle stage. The following output list is aligned with the implemented project flow.

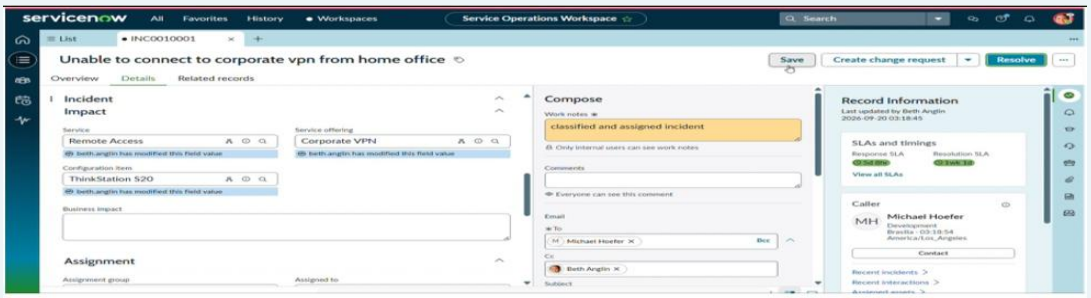
- Output 1 – Incident created in Service Operations Workspace.
- Output 2 – Incident classification and Service / Service Offering / CI.
- Output 3 – Agent Assist knowledge article attached and marked helpful.
- Output 4 – Watch list and work-note followers.
- Output 5 – Reassignment to Network / Level 2 support.
- Output 6 – Configuration Item updated and On Hold / Awaiting Change.
- Output 7 – Emergency Change Request linked to incident.
- Output 8 – Child Incident listed under Related Records.
- Output 9 – Cause, resolution code, resolution notes and Resolved state.
- Output 10 – Knowledge Article created and SLA visible.

7.1 Output Screenshots – Incident Lifecycle

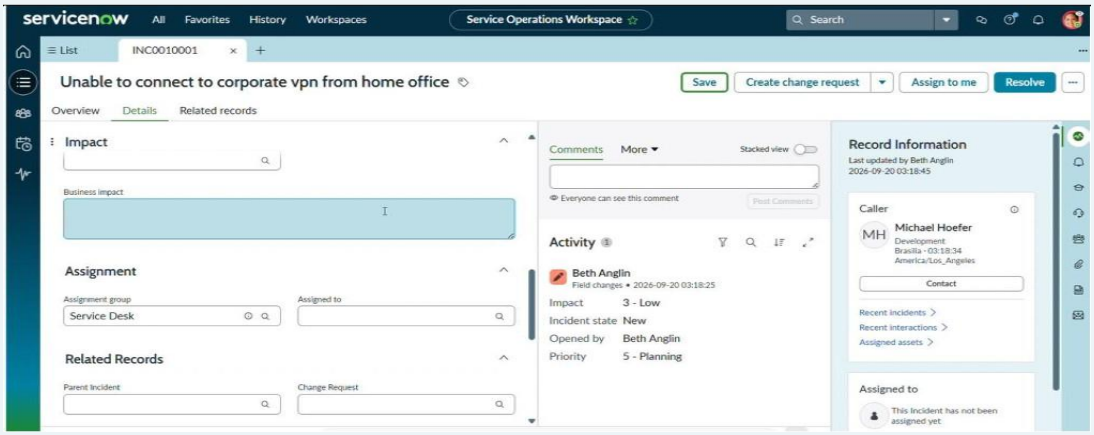
1. Incident creation / Agent Assist



2. Incident classification details

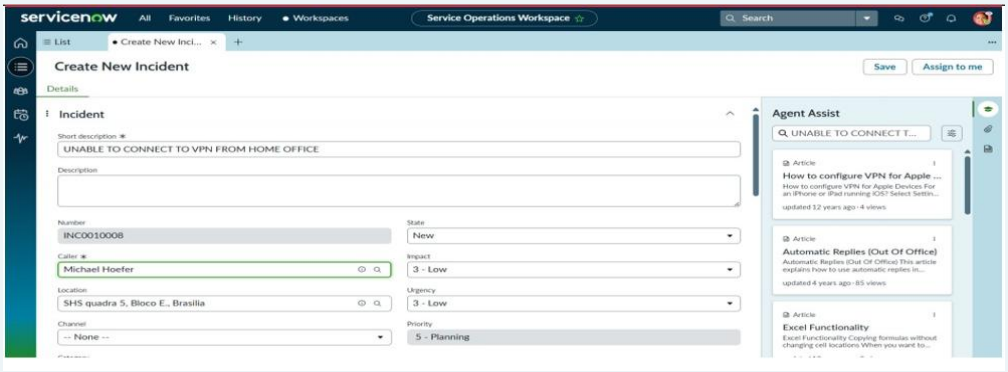


3. Assignment to Service Desk

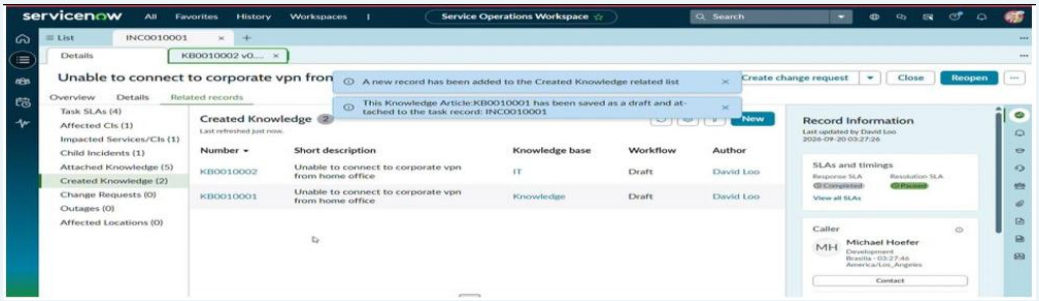


7.1 Output Screenshots – Resolution & Knowledge

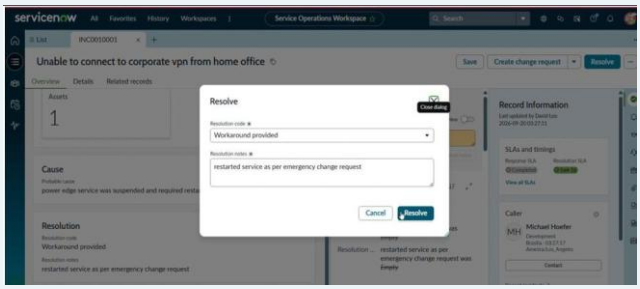
4. Incident creation with Agent Assist



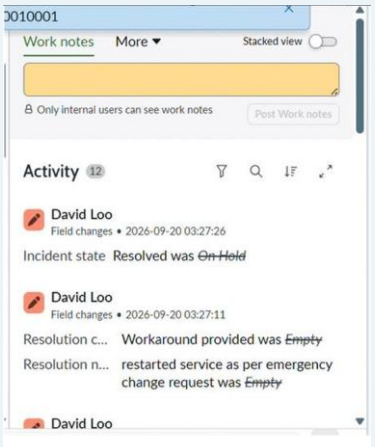
5. Knowledge article created and linked



6. Resolution dialog / workaround



7. Activity history showing resolution



8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages	Disadvantages / Limitations
Standardized incident intake and classification.	Solution depends on correct ServiceNow configuration and permissions.
Knowledge support can reduce repeated troubleshooting.	Knowledge quality depends on available and maintained articles.
Clear Level 2 ownership and escalation.	Resolution may still depend on support-team availability.
Emergency change linkage improves traceability.	Emergency changes still require appropriate change governance.
Child incidents provide structured tracking for related issues.	Additional related records increase process administration.
Cause and resolution documentation improves history and reuse.	Manual data entry is still required for some fields.
Knowledge creation turns resolved work into reusable guidance.	Generated knowledge still requires review and maintenance.
SLA tracking improves visibility of service performance.	SLA configuration must match organizational policies.

Project Impact

- Faster and more standardized incident handling.
- Improved visibility across Service Desk and Level 2 teams.
- Better linkage between incident, change, child incident, knowledge, and SLA records.
- Reusable resolution knowledge for future incidents.
- Clearer ownership and activity history throughout the lifecycle.

9. CONCLUSION

The Automated Incident Management Lifecycle project demonstrates how ServiceNow can be configured to standardize incident handling from creation through resolution. The solution connects incident classification, Agent Assist, Level 2 escalation, emergency change integration, child incidents, resolution documentation, knowledge creation, and SLA tracking.

By maintaining related records within the incident lifecycle, the project provides a clearer operational trail for Service Desk and technical support teams. The process also turns successful resolutions into reusable knowledge, supporting continuous improvement.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

- Add automated assignment rules based on category, service, CI, or impact.
- Integrate monitoring/event management to create incidents automatically.
- Add richer SLA dashboards and proactive escalation notifications.
- Use AI-assisted incident summarization and resolution recommendation.
- Expand Knowledge Management with article quality and feedback analytics.
- Integrate CMDB health and dependency information for faster root-cause analysis.
- Add automated change-risk checks before emergency change submission.
- Introduce trend analytics for recurring incidents and problem-management handoff.

11. APPENDIX

A. Core ServiceNow Records / Areas Used

Record / Area	Meaning	Project Use
incident	Incident record	Stores caller, classification, assignment, work notes, state and resolution.
kb_knowledge	Knowledge Article	Stores reusable troubleshooting and resolution guidance.
sys_user	User	Supports caller, watcher, follower and assigned-user references.
cmdb_ci	Configuration Item	Identifies the technical CI affected by the incident.
cmdb_ci_service	Business / Technical Service	Represents Remote Access service.
service_offering	Service Offering	Represents Corporate VPN offering.
Change Request	Change record	Tracks emergency change required for incident resolution.
Child Incident	Related incident	Tracks related or recurring incident work.
Task SLA	SLA record	Provides SLA timing and compliance visibility.

B. Acceptance Criteria

- Service Desk agent can create an incident with caller and short description.
- Incident classification captures the required service, offering, urgency, category, subcategory and CI.
- Agent Assist shows relevant knowledge and allows an article to be attached.
- Incident can be reassigned to Network / Level 2 support with clear ownership.
- Emergency change can be created and linked from the incident.
- Child incident can be created and verified under Related Records.
- Probable cause, resolution code and resolution notes are recorded before resolution.
- Resolved incident can generate a Knowledge Article.
- SLA and related records remain visible for lifecycle tracking.
- Parent and child incident activity provides a traceable resolution history.

C. Project Milestones

Incident Record Creation → Incident Classification → Knowledge Integration → Reassignment & Escalation → Change Request Creation → Child Incident Creation → Incident Resolution → Knowledge Creation → SLA & Related Record Validation.